HrClouds HRMS — HR User Onboarding & Setup Workflow Guide

Document Version: 2.1
Target Audience: HR Administrators, People Operations & System Admins
Platform URL: `https://frontend.dev.hrclouds.in`
Purpose: Streamlined, step-by-step navigation and execution guide for HR administrators setting up the organization, configuring attendance rules, creating shifts, inviting employees, and provisioning leave quotas.

Master Setup Order Flowchart

Follow this sequential workflow strictly. Each step provides the foundational data required by the next step:



Core Sequential Rules

> ***1. Locations before Departments:*** *Departments must be bound to a physical office location.*
> ***2. Policies & Shifts before Invites:*** *Attendance rules, working hours, and holiday calendars must exist before employees clock in on Day 1.*
> ***3. Invites before Shift & Leave Assignments:*** *You cannot assign shifts or leave quotas to an employee until their user account exists in the system.*

PHASE 1: Organisation Foundation

Set up your physical workplace and departments.

Step 1A: Create Office Locations

- **Sidebar Path:** `SETUP` > `Organisation` > `Office Locations`
- **Direct URL:** `/dashboard/hr/attendance/locations`
- **Goal:** Register your office building and set up GPS geofencing boundaries for mobile attendance.

Execution Steps:

1. Navigate to **Office Locations** (`/dashboard/hr/attendance/locations`).
2. Click the `+ Add Location` button at the top-right.
3. Fill in the location details: Name, Code, Timezone, and full street Address.
4. On the map pane, click to position your GPS marker pin (or enter Latitude and Longitude).
5. Set the **Geofence Radius** (recommended: `150` meters).
6. Fill in City, State, Country, and Pincode.
7. Click `Create Location`.

```
# Example Data:
  Location Name: Indore Head Office
  Location Code: IND-HO
  Time Zone: Asia/Kolkata (IST +05:30)
  Address: Plot No. 42, Scheme 54, PU-4 Commercial Complex, Vijay Nagar
  Latitude: 22.7533
  Longitude: 75.8937
  Geofence Radius: 150 meters
  City: Indore, State: Madhya Pradesh, Pincode: 452010
```

Step 1B: Create Departments

- **Sidebar Path:** `SETUP` > `Organisation` > `Departments`
- **Direct URL:** `/dashboard/hr/departments`
- **Goal:** Create organizational units (Engineering, HR, Sales) and connect them to your office location.

Execution Steps:

1. Navigate to **Departments** (`/dashboard/hr/departments`).
2. Click the `+ Add Department` button at the top-right.
3. Enter the **Department Name** and a short **Department Code**.
4. Select the **Location** from the dropdown (choose the office created in Step 1A).
5. *(Optional)* Select a **Head of Department** (can be left blank during initial setup).

6. Enter a brief Description and make sure **Department is Active** is checked.
7. Click `Save Department`.
8. Repeat for all company departments (e.g., *IT*, *HR*, *Finance*, *Sales*).

```
# Example Data:
  Department Name: Information Technology
  Department Code: IT
  Location: Indore Head Office
  Head of Department: Unassigned (Set after staff join)
  Description: Software engineering, cloud infrastructure, and technical support.
  Department is Active: Yes
```

PHASE 2: Time & Attendance Master Flow

Configure working hours, holiday schedules, and attendance rules **before inviting any employees**.

Step 2A: Create Attendance Policies

- **Sidebar Path:** `SETUP` > `Time` > `Attendance Policies`
- **Direct URL:** `/dashboard/hr/attendance/policies`
- **Goal:** Configure allowed clock-in methods, arrival grace time, and late arrival penalties.

Execution Steps:

1. Navigate to **Attendance Policies** (`/dashboard/hr/attendance/policies`).
2. Click `Create Policy` (or `+ Add Policy`) at the top-right.
3. Enter the **Policy Name** and set **Priority** to `1`.
4. Choose **Punch Mode** as `Web & Mobile`.
5. Enable **Allow Web Punch**, **Allow Mobile Punch**, and **Require Location / Geofence**.
6. Set **Late Arrival Grace Period** (e.g., `15` minutes).
7. Select **Late Mark Action** (e.g., `Flag Late & Alert Manager`).
8. Enable **Earn Earned Leave for Holiday Work**.
9. Leave scope set to *All Departments* and *All Locations* for company-wide coverage.
10. Click `Save Policy`.

```
# Example Data:
  Policy Name: Standard Office Attendance Policy 2026
  Priority: 1
  Punch Mode: Web & Mobile (Geofenced)
  Late Arrival Grace Period: 15 minutes
  Late Mark Action: Mark Late (3 late marks = 0.5 Day Loss of Pay)
  Earn Earned Leave for Holiday Work: Enabled
  Applies To: All Locations, All Departments
```

Step 2B: Create Work Shifts

- **Sidebar Path:** `SETUP` > `Time` > `Work Shifts`
- **Direct URL:** `/dashboard/hr/attendance/shifts`
- **Goal:** Define scheduled shift hours, meal breaks, and Half-Day / Full-Day work duration thresholds.

> ***IMPORTANT:*** *In this step, you are only creating the shift template. You will assign this shift to employees* ***in Phase 4*** *after they accept their onboarding invitation.*

Execution Steps:

1. Navigate to **Work Shifts** (`/dashboard/hr/attendance/shifts`).
2. Click `+ Add Shift` at the top-right.
3. Enter **Shift Name** and **Shift Code**.
4. Set **Shift Type** to `Fixed Hours`.
5. Set scheduled **Start Time** (e.g., `09:30 AM`) and **End Time** (e.g., `06:30 PM`).
6. Set **Break Duration** (e.g., `60` minutes).
7. Set **Half Day Minimum Hours** (e.g., `4.5` hours) and **Full Day Minimum Hours** (e.g., `8.0` hours).
8. Set **Grace Period** (e.g., `15` minutes).
9. Click `Save Shift`.

```
# Example Data:
  Shift Name: General Day Shift (9:30 AM - 6:30 PM)
  Shift Code: GEN-01
  Shift Type: Fixed Hours
  Start Time: 09:30 AM
  End Time: 06:30 PM
  Break Duration: 60 minutes
  Half Day Minimum Hours: 4.5 hours
  Full Day Minimum Hours: 8.0 hours
  Grace Period: 15 minutes
```

Step 2C: Setup Public & Company Holidays

- **Sidebar Path:** `SETUP` > `Time` > `Holidays`
- **Direct URL:** `/dashboard/hr/attendance/holidays`
- **Goal:** Publish mandatory paid public holidays and optional festival holidays for the year.

Execution Steps:

1. Navigate to **Holidays** (`/dashboard/hr/attendance/holidays`).
2. Select the operational year (e.g., `2026`) from the year dropdown.
3. Click `+ Add Holiday` (or `Import Calendar` for pre-populated lists).
4. Enter the **Holiday Name** and select the **Date**.
5. Choose **Type** as `Mandatory` (or `Optional` for floating holidays).
6. Under **Applicable Locations**, select `All Locations`.
7. Click `Save Holiday`.
8. Repeat for your full annual holiday schedule.

```
# Example Data:
  Holiday Name: Republic Day
  Date: 26-01-2026
  Type: Mandatory
  Applicable Locations: All Locations
```

Step 2D: Setup Weekly Offs

- **Sidebar Path:** `SETUP` > `Time` > `Weekly Offs`
- **Direct URL:** `/dashboard/hr/attendance/weekly-offs`
- **Goal:** Define weekly non-working rest days (e.g., 5-day week, 6-day week, or alternate Saturdays).

Execution Steps:

1. Navigate to **Weekly Offs** (`/dashboard/hr/attendance/weekly-offs`).
2. Click `+ Add Rule` (or `Add Policy`).
3. Enter a **Policy Name** and set **Priority** to `1` .
4. Under **Work Days**, toggle ON: `Monday` , `Tuesday` , `Wednesday` , `Thursday` , `Friday` . (Leave `Saturday` and `Sunday` OFF).
5. Under **Alternate Saturday Schedule**, select `All Saturdays are off` .
6. Under **Applies To**, select `All Departments` and `All Locations` .
7. Click `Save Policy` .

```
# Example Data:
  Policy Name: Corporate 5-Day Work Week (Mon-Fri)
  Work Days: Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday, Thursday, Friday
  Weekly Off Days: Saturday, Sunday
  Alternate Saturday Rule: All Saturdays are off
  Applies To: All Departments
```

Step 2E: Setup Earned Leave Policies (Comp-Off)

- **Sidebar Path:** `SETUP` > `Time` > `Comp-Off Policies`
- **Direct URL:** `/dashboard/hr/attendance/comp-off-policies`
- **Goal:** Reward staff with compensatory off credits when they work on scheduled weekly offs or holidays.

Execution Steps:

1. Navigate to **Comp-Off Policies** (`/dashboard/hr/attendance/comp-off-policies`).
2. Click `+ Add policy` at the top-right.
3. Enter the **Policy Name**.
4. Set **Hours for half day** to `4.0` and **Hours for full day** to `8.0` .
5. Set **Multiplier** to `1.0` .
6. Set **Valid for (days)** to `60` (credits expire after 2 months).
7. Set **Maximum balance** to `5.0` days.
8. Check **Requires manager approval**.
9. Click `Save Policy` .

```
# Example Data:
  Policy Name: Standard Compensatory Off Policy
  Hours for Half Day: 4.0 hours
  Hours for Full Day: 8.0 hours
  Multiplier: 1.0
  Validity: 60 days
  Maximum Balance Cap: 5.0 days
  Requires Manager Approval: Yes
```

PHASE 3: People Onboarding — Inviting Team Members

Now that organization, attendance, shifts, and holiday policies are ready, you can safely issue invitations.

Step 3A: Issue Employee Invitations via the 4-Step Wizard

- **Sidebar Path:** `PEOPLE` > `Invites`
- **Direct URL:** `/dashboard/hr/invites`
- **Goal:** Pre-fill candidate profile and work details, and generate a 48-hour email activation link.

> ***CRITICAL PERMANENT FIELDS: Role & Gender***
> *The **Role** (`HR`, `Manager`, `Employee`) and **Gender** (`Male`, `Female`, `Other`) fields **cannot be changed from the profile after onboarding**. Verify both carefully before sending.*

The 4 Accordion Steps:

- **Step 1: Required Information** — Name, Work Email, Role, Gender, Employee ID.
- **Step 2: Profile Details** — Mobile Phone, Personal Email, DOB, Marital Status, Blood Group, Designation.
- **Step 3: Organization & Work** — Office Location, Department, Reporting Manager, Job Status, Employment Type, Work Mode, Joining Date.

  > *Rule: If inviting a Manager or HR, their Reporting Person must strictly be an HR user.*
- **Step 4: Compliance & Address** — PAN, UAN, Residential Address, City, State, Pincode.

Execution Steps:

1. Navigate to **Invites** (`/dashboard/hr/invites`).
2. Click the `+ New invite` button at the top-right.
3. Complete **Step 1 (Required Information)**: Name, Work Email, Role, Gender.
4. Expand **Step 2 (Profile Details)**: Phone, DOB, Blood Group, Designation.
5. Expand **Step 3 (Organization & Work)**: Select Location, Department, Reporting Person, Job Status, Employment Type, Work Mode, and Joining Date.

6. Expand **Step 4 (Compliance & Address)**: Enter PAN, UAN, and Address (check *Same as Current*).
7. Click `Send Invitation`.
8. The invite moves to the **Waiting** tab with a 48-hour expiration timer.

```
# Example Data:
  Full Name: Aman Sharma
  Email Address: aman.sharma@yourcompany.com
  Role: Employee
  Gender: Male
  Primary Contact: +91 9876543210
  Designation: Full Stack Developer
  Location: Indore Head Office
  Department: Information Technology
  Reporting Person: Abhishek HR
  Job Status: Probation
  Employment Type: Full Time
  Work Mode: On-site
  Joining Date: 01-11-2026
```

Step 3B: Employee Accepts Invitation

- The employee receives an activation email with a secure link (valid for 48 hours).
- The employee sets their password and logs into the self-service portal.
- On the HR Invites dashboard, their status updates from **Waiting** to **Accepted**.
- The employee now appears in the active **Team Directory** (`/dashboard/hr/employees`).

PHASE 4: Post-Join Setup — Scheduling & Leaves

Perform these steps **after** the employee accepts their invitation and appears in the Team Directory.

Step 4A: Assign Work Shift to the Joined Employee

- **Sidebar Path:** `SETUP` > `Time` > `Shift Assignments` (or `Roster`)
- **Direct URL:** `/dashboard/hr/attendance/shift-assignments`
- **Goal:** Assign the shift template created in Step 2B to the onboarded employee.

Execution Steps:

1. Navigate to **Shift Assignments** (or Roster: `/dashboard/hr/attendance/roster`).
2. Locate the employee (or click `Bulk Assign Shift`).

3. Select the shift: `General Day Shift (9:30 AM - 6:30 PM)`.
4. Select the employee: `Aman Sharma` (or select entire Department: `Information Technology`).
5. Set **Effective From Date** as their joining date.
6. Leave **Effective To Date** blank for an ongoing permanent schedule.
7. Click `Confirm Shift Assignment`.

Step 4B: Create Leave Types

- **Sidebar Path:** `SETUP` > `Leave` > `Leave Types`
- **Direct URL:** `/dashboard/hr/leaves/types`
- **Goal:** Create the leave categories your company offers (e.g., Casual Leave, Sick Leave, Maternity Leave).

Execution Steps:

1. Navigate to **Leave Types** (`/dashboard/hr/leaves/types`).
2. Click `+ Add Leave Type` at the top-right.
3. Configure **Casual Leave (CL)**:
   - Name: `Casual Leave`, Code: `CL`.
   - Toggle **Paid Leave** to `ON`.
   - Toggle **Count Weekends In Between** to `OFF` (sandwich rule off).
   - Click `Save Leave Type`.
4. Click `+ Add Leave Type` again to configure **Sick Leave (SL)**:
   - Name: `Sick Leave`, Code: `SL`.
   - Toggle **Paid Leave** to `ON`.
   - Set **Document Required After** to `2` days (medical certificate needed for 3+ consecutive days).
   - Click `Save Leave Type`.

```
# Example Data:
  Leave Type 1: Casual Leave (CL) | Paid: Yes | Sandwich Rule: Off | Doc Required: None
  Leave Type 2: Sick Leave (SL)   | Paid: Yes | Sandwich Rule: Off | Doc Required: Afte
  r 2 days
```

Step 4C: Create Leave Policies (Quota Templates)

- **Sidebar Path:** `SETUP` > `Leave` > `Leave Policies`
- **Direct URL:** `/dashboard/hr/leaves/policies`
- **Goal:** Bundle leave types into an annual quota package with accrual and carry-forward rules.

Execution Steps:

1. Navigate to **Leave Policies** (`/dashboard/hr/leaves/policies`).
2. Click `Create Policy` at top-right.
3. Enter Policy Name as `Standard Full-Time Leave Policy 2026` and click `Save Policy Template`.
4. On the generated card, click `+ Add Quota` to attach **Casual Leave (CL)**:
   - Leave Type: `Casual Leave (CL)`.
   - Days Per Year: `12`.
   - How Leave Is Given: `Every month` (1 day credited each month).
   - Unused Days Kept For Next Year: `3` days.
   - Wait After Joining: `30` days.
   - Click `Save Quota`.
5. Click `+ Add Quota` again to attach **Sick Leave (SL)**:
   - Leave Type: `Sick Leave (SL)`.
   - Days Per Year: `10`.
   - How Leave Is Given: `All at once` (available on Day 1).
   - Unused Days Kept: `0` (lapses at year end).
   - Click `Save Quota`.

```
# Example Data:
  Policy Name: Standard Full-Time Leave Policy 2026
  Quota 1: Casual Leave (CL) -> 12 days/yr | Accrual: Monthly (1/mo) | Rollover: 3 days
  max
  Quota 2: Sick Leave (SL)   -> 10 days/yr | Accrual: All at once   | Rollover: 0 (Laps
  es)
```

Step 4D: Assign Leave Policies to Employees

- **Sidebar Path:** `SETUP` > `Leave` > `Leave Policies`
- **Direct URL:** `/dashboard/hr/leaves/policies`
- **Goal:** Enroll onboarded employees into the leave quota package.

Execution Steps:

1. On the **Leave Policies** page, locate the card: `Standard Full-Time Leave Policy 2026`.
2. Click the `Assign` button on that card.
3. Select targets: Choose individual employee (`Aman Sharma`) or select by department (`Information Technology`).
4. Verify policy selection and preview quota allocations.
5. Click `Confirm & Assign Policy`.
6. The employee's leave balance is initialized and active.

Daily Operations Summary

- **HR Inbox** (`/dashboard/hr/inbox`): Approve leave requests, regularize missed attendance punches, sign off overtime, and resolve system attendance flags.
- **Team Directory** (`/dashboard/hr/employees`): View staff cards, reporting lines, and monthly attendance calendars.
- **Daily Attendance** (`/dashboard/hr/attendance/daily`): Real-time live dashboard of present, late, on-leave, and absent staff with GPS verification.

Master Setup Checklist

Print this reference checklist to track your onboarding progress:

Phase	Step	Task Description	Target Portal URL	Done
Phase 1	**1A**	Create Office Location & Geofence	`/dashboard/hr/attendance/locations`	[ ]
Phase 1	**1B**	Create Organizational Departments	`/dashboard/hr/departments`	[ ]
Phase 2	**2A**	Create Attendance Policy (Grace time, Punch modes)	`/dashboard/hr/attendance/policies`	[ ]
Phase 2	**2B**	Create Work Shift Templates (Start/End hours)	`/dashboard/hr/attendance/shifts`	[ ]
Phase 2	**2C**	Publish Public & Company Holiday Calendar	`/dashboard/hr/attendance/holidays`	[ ]
Phase 2	**2D**	Configure Weekly Offs (5-Day / Alternate Sat)	`/dashboard/hr/attendance/weekly-offs`	[ ]
Phase 2	**2E**	Setup Earned Leave (Comp-Off) Rules	`/dashboard/hr/attendance/comp-off-policies`	[ ]
Phase 3	**3A**	Issue Employee Invites via 4-Step Wizard	`/dashboard/hr/invites`	[ ]
Phase 3	**3B**	Employee Accepts Invite & Creates Password	*48-hr Email Link*	[ ]
Phase 4	**4A**	Assign Shift in Roster / Shift Assignments	`/dashboard/hr/attendance/shift-assignments`	[ ]
Phase 4	**4B**	Create Leave Types (CL, SL, ML)	`/dashboard/hr/leaves/types`	[ ]
Phase 4	**4C**	Assemble Leave Policy & Attach Annual Quotas	`/dashboard/hr/leaves/policies`	[ ]
Phase 4	**4D**	Assign Leave Policy to Onboarded Employees	`/dashboard/hr/leaves/policies`	[ ]

HrClouds HRMS User Onboarding & Setup Workflow Guide — Streamlined for rapid execution and clean PDF printing.